

Boom time

In addition to changing the way we make goods, the manufacturing industries that emerged during the Industrial Revolution in the late 18th century altered almost every aspect of our lives. Industrialized societies prospered, especially the new class of capitalists, the mill and factory owners, whose goods supplied an increasing number of stores. But these goods need buyers. Much of the wealth went to the business owners, while the workers earned wages from their jobs in the new industries. There were now more people, especially in towns and cities, needing to buy necessities, and an increasing number of rich businesspeople wanting to buy luxury goods. The market—the supply and demand for these goods—grew. Production increased in line with demand, and the economy of industrial societies flourished as industries supplied ever more manufactured goods and found ways of producing them more efficiently. Increased demand drove down prices of everyday goods, as producers vied for business.